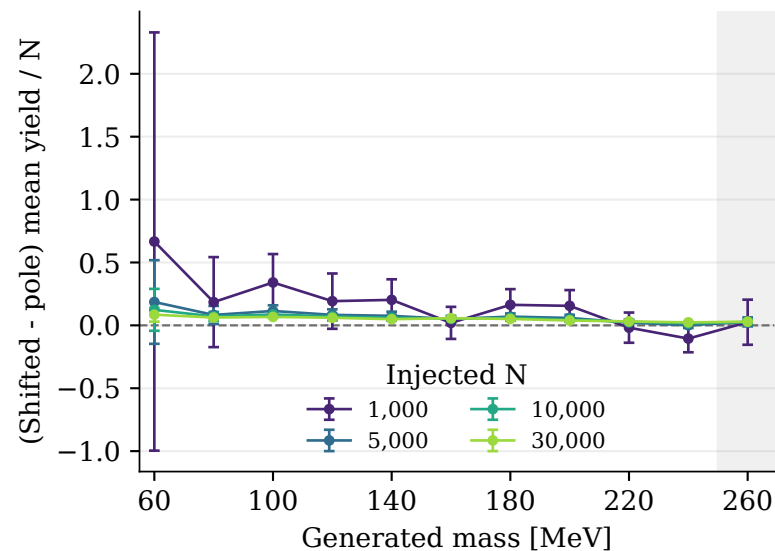


Paired extraction difference



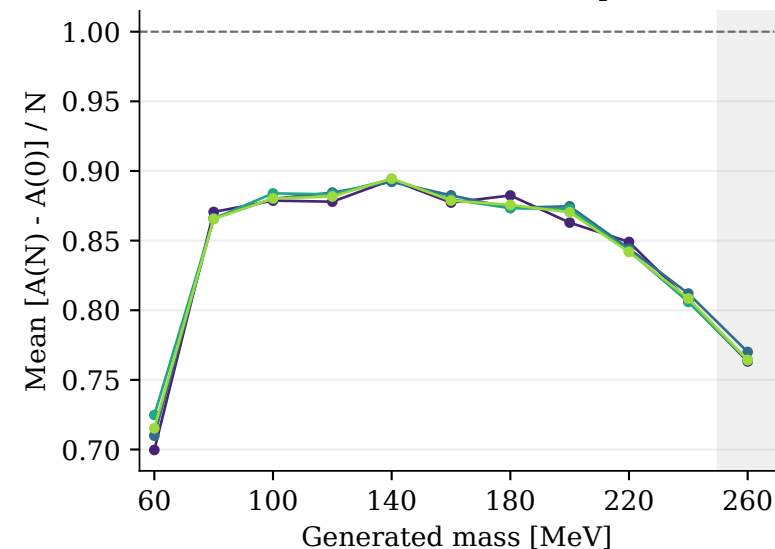
## Same toy, two masks

Upper left: a positive value means the shifted mask extracts more signal.

Below: subtract each method's paired zero-injection fit before dividing by  $N$ . This separates the incremental response from the zero-injection offset.

The two estimates share the same background and MC injection draws.

Pole-centered: incremental response



MC-core-shifted: incremental response

